

LEARN MODERN STRIPES



**MACHINE KNIT
WITH KNIT-1**



Modern Stripes

This book includes:

- ❖ Great stripe combinations in 2, 3 and multi colours.
- ❖ Ombre stripe, blurring, weaving, breaking and curving a stripe.
- ❖ Short row techniques, diagonal striping and how to knit chevrons.
- ❖ 9 Fully explained techniques.
- ❖ 25 design/swatch examples.

Provides references to relevant artists and fashion designers to further explore these striking effects.

“I can safely say I will never think about stripes the same way again. Stripes appear simple and too easy, but they can be so much more.”- Andrea (Canada) Jan 08.

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For more copies of this book, please email: orders@knit-1.com

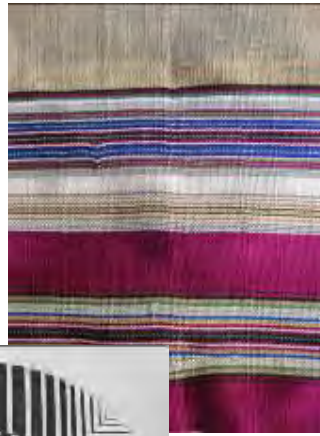


Inspiration



Stripes may seem simple but to make an impactful stripe you must think carefully about colour composition, and rhythm. These examples show just two of the many themes around stripes- multicoloured/ethnic and two-coloured/graphic.

This garment is an excellent example of a multi coloured beautifully composed stripe. Many strong colours have been used but the overall effect is not overpowering.



- ❖ Ethnic textiles are excellent sources of inspiration for stripes.

This black and white dress shows how effective a simple stripe in just two colours can be. The varying width of the stripe and the strong chevrons make it striking.

Look at artists such as Bridget Riley and her Op-Art. Try to interpret a picture, just for practise and even if reproducing it exactly proves too complicated, trying to will throw up some interesting swatches.



- ❖ Gather together a collection of stripe images in bright colours or black and white. These are images from a OP-Art book, Dries Van Noten, Spring 2009 and Junya Watanabe Fall 2003.







Black and White stripes with a hint of colour look great!

Ok let's Stripe!

With two colours (A and B) threaded through the yarn tension unit (antennae), practise colour changing and differing width of stripes by;

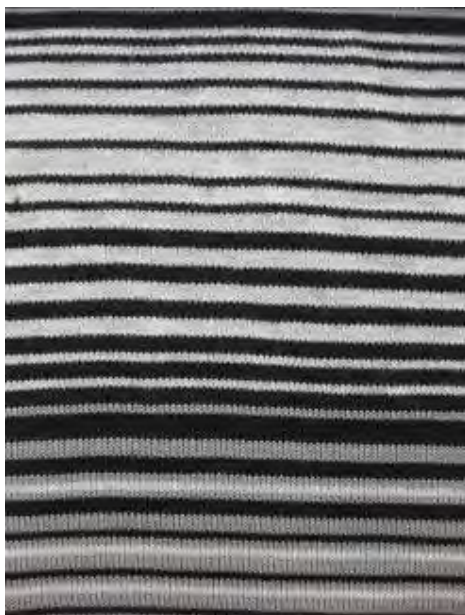


- ❖ Knitting 4 rows colour A then 4 rows colour B or 4x4 stripe.
- ❖ Knit 20 rows A.
- ❖ Knit 2 rows A, 2 rows B or 2x2 stripe.
- ❖ Knit 20 rows B.

- ❖ Repeat sections.
- ❖ See how many combinations of 4 and 2 row stripes you can knit.

For example try;

- ❖ Knit 4xA 4xB 2xA 2xB repeat.
- ❖ Or knit * 4xA 4xB repeat 4 times.
- ❖ 2xA 2xB repeat 4 times.
Repeat from *





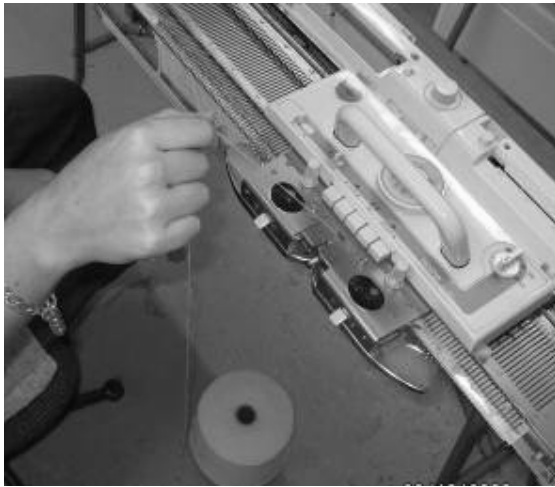
- ❖ Now adding a colour C to antennae 3 or feeding yarn from the floor, try 3 colour combinations.



This is a vintage garment that's using a horizontal and vertical stripe!

To feed from the Floor

Place yarn directly under your carriage on the right, and effectively make your right hand do the job of the antennae. Don't hold too tightly let the yarn run smoothly through your hand.



So vary the width of the stripe and the colour combination;

❖ Knit 2x A 2xB 2xC, 4xA 4xB 4xC, 2xC 2xB 2xA repeat.

❖ Or 4xA, 4xB repeat 4xB, 4xC repeat 4xA 4xC repeat.

Now you can stripe with as many different colours or tones as you like.



If you are using lots of colours or tones It is easier to stripe with yarn feeding from the floor as it is quicker than changing it through the feeder.



These are found scarves and ties, all printed or woven but all with amazing stripe composition!

It might be easier to take away the colour and look at the examples in monochrome. Just focus on the width of the stripes and how they repeat.



- ❖ Look at the pieces of fabric you've just knitted as a design, how would they work on the body?
- ❖ Start to pin your swatches on a dress form, stand back and consider what looks good.

- ❖ If you knitted one long swatch don't be afraid to cut it into interesting sections you like and re-knitting as a design.



Ombre Stripe

An ombre stripe is a stripe made of tones that get progressively lighter or darker.



The above photos are examples of ombre stripes.

- ❖ To knit the example on the right you will need 4 tones from light to dark.
-With A being the darkest.
- ❖ Knit 4xA 4xB 4xC 4xD then 4xD 4xC 4xB 4xA so D is really x8 rows in the centre. Or reverse so 4xD 4xC 4xB 8xA 4xB 4xC 4xD.
- ❖ Or stripe 10xA, 2XB,8XA, 4XB,6XA,6XB,4XA,8XB,2XA,10XB repeat with other tones as in the picture above left to make a longer ombre.
- ❖ Combine an ombre stripe with some of your previous stripes to make it more interesting.

Stripe Manipulation

Now we can play with basic stripe and blur it, curve it, make it diagonal or just more interesting,

Try it!



- ❖ This was achieved by striping a cotton yarn and a lambswool yarn, the resist washing. So knit your sample tie portions tightly with synthetic yarn as if you were to Tie - Dye it and wash in a machine at 40 degrees.



Look at the Catwalk for stripe inspiration and interpret there designs in your own way!

Blurring

If you buy a metal bristled brush from a haberdashery shop you can simply brush the right side surface of your swatch. This works best on hairy yarns, a washed lambswool or mohair work particularly well, brush very hard and in one direction.

See these stripy examples for before and after shots.



- ❖ Always steam all you're knitting. It's easier to see what you have made and it closes the stitches very slightly. Even the worst looking scraps are worthy of something.
- ❖ Washing a fabric you've made will almost always improve the look and the handle. If you hand wash a sample with warm water and some detergent you have more control over how the fabric will change.

Weaving



This technique is only possible on a Brother machine.!!

A technique that looks more pronounced on the wrong (purl) side of the fabric than the right side but with the right yarn choice can be very effective.

Use it to break up a stripe like this.

- ❖ Knit a piece of fabric and select every other needle with your Needle Pusher to position D.



- ❖ With your main yarn (A) in feeder A, have yarn B resting in the metal V at the side of the carriage in the direction you are knitting.

- ❖ Knit one row then change yarn B to the direction you are knitting and knit back.



- ❖ Here I have knitted in yarn A woven for a couple of rows then knitted in yarn B.

- ❖ Try knitting equal blocks (20rows) of plain colour, weaving, striping, weaving, knitting plain and repeat.

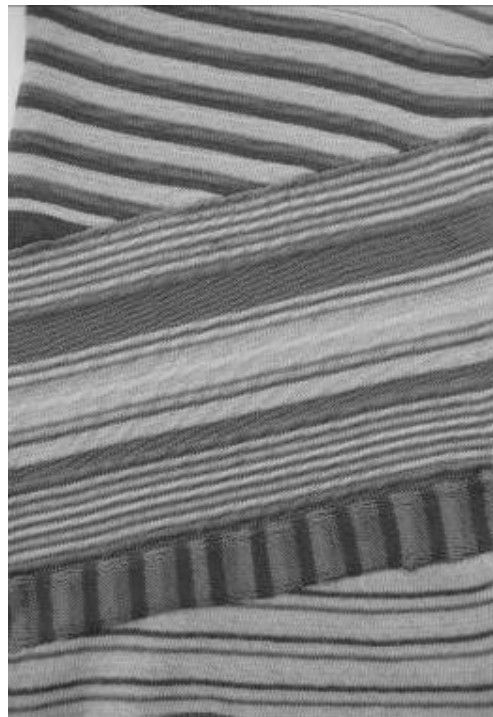
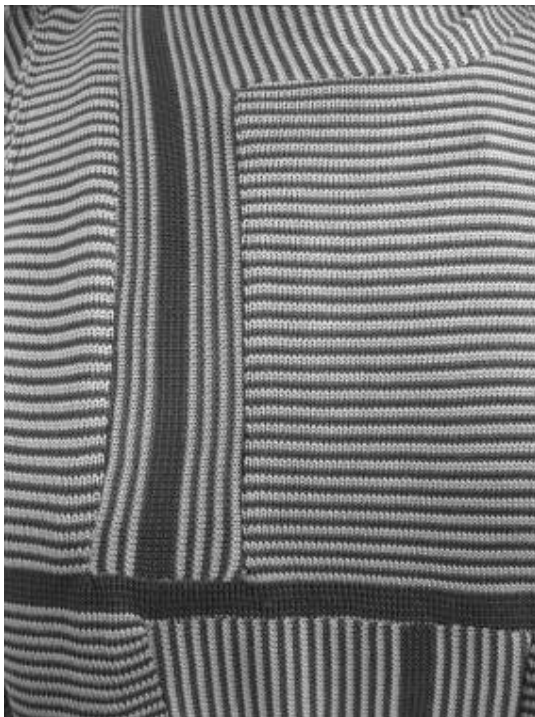
The photograph is of 'woven' stripes with a section not weaving but hooked on to the last needle of the swatch to create an engineered float.

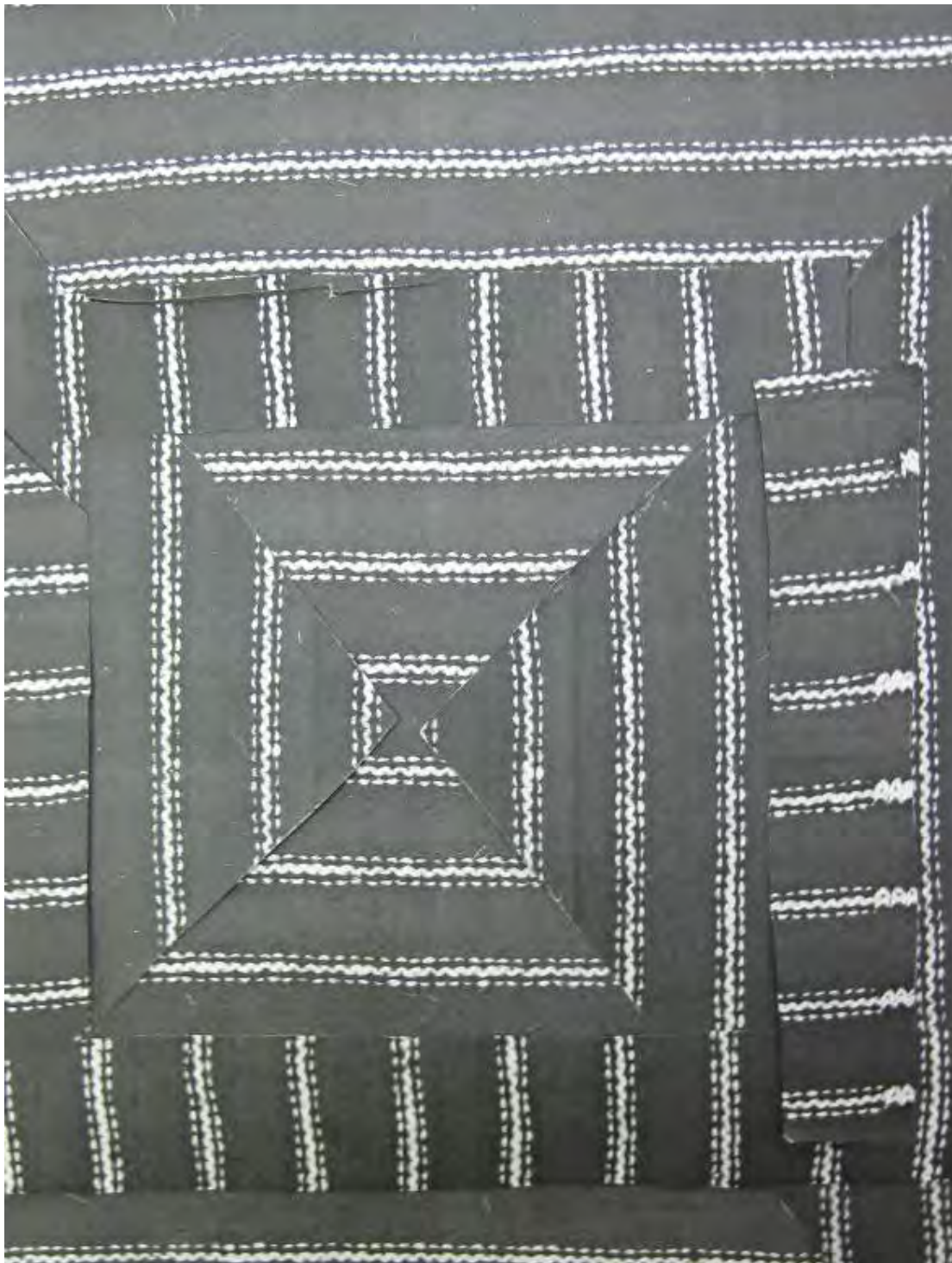


The example on the right is engineering the weaving; by changing the selection of needles you're weaving every row to create a zigzag.

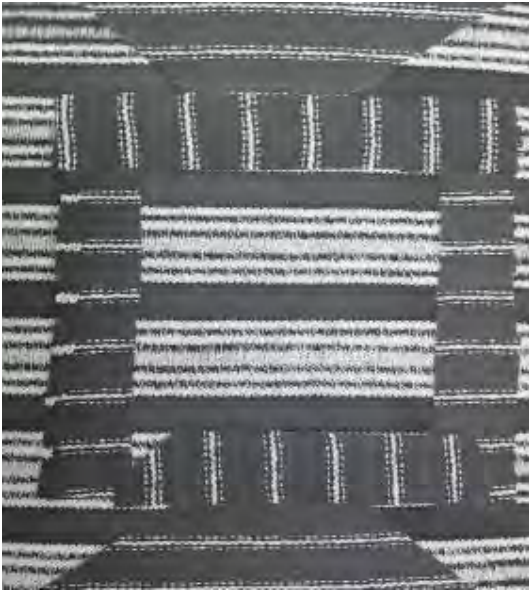
Now you have knitted some straight striped fabric;

- ❖ Try cutting them up and sewing back together either by hand or machine in different directions.





- ❖ Or photocopy your stripes and play with the paper making new designs.



Then copy the paper designs in your cut and sew fabric.

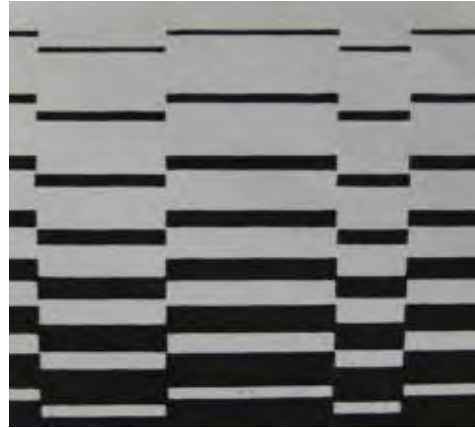


Now we will try to knit designs like these as one fabric, changing direction integrally in the fabric, and utilising all the stripe combinations you have come up with.



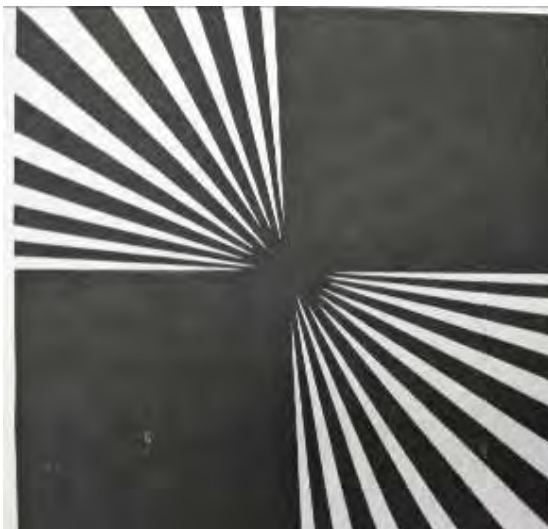
Using the Holding Cam (Short Row knitting)

Short row knitting is a technique used mainly for garment construction-skirt darts, shaping necklines and shoulders, hemlines and sock heels- or as one way to knit an intarsia look. It is a way of changing the direction of the knitting from within the fabric, we will use it a lot to build extra fabric but for now we are concerned with stripes.



Your stripe is a line.

This line can be thin or thick and it can move in whichever direction you like- when you get clever with the holding cam.



Short row knitting essentially means knitting a row of stitches part way across the fabric, turning, and knitting back; then knitting fewer stitches across, turning back, and repeating.

So decreasing the number of stitches each time.





Create a statement piece by mirroring your fabrics together!





The technique also works in reverse; starting with a couple of stitches and increasing each row.



Breaking and Curving a Stripe.

- ❖ Select the needles you don't want to knit, pull them out to position E.
- ❖ On your machine carriage change holding cam from N to H on a Brother machine
- ❖ Change cams from II to I on a Knitmaster.
- ❖ To select needles back in to working action push back to position D.



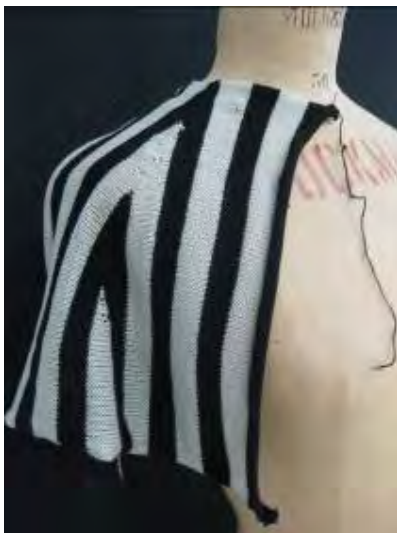
- ❖ Try simply pulling half the needles of your swatch into holding position.
- ❖ Knit across and back (2 rows) Yarn A.
- ❖ Change colour and knit all needles back into action, by changing the carriage setting back to N.



Try this Shape!



- ❖ Cast on 40 st. and knit 10 rows.
- ❖ Start with all needles in working position.
- ❖ Change carriage settings to hold.
- ❖ *On the left side of swatch pull out 2 needles into E position.
- ❖ Knit 2 rows. Repeat from * pulling out 2 more needles every 2 rows.
- ❖ Stripe as you knit – every 2 rows.
- ❖ When you have 20 needles in holding position, push the needles back to position D 2x2 rows and match the stripes.



- ❖ Keep trying swatches on the dress form- the short row technique will give you shapes you can utilise.





This swatch is a 4x4 stripe split on a diagonal.



- ❖ To repeat this look, on a swatch 40 needles wide, pull 20 needles at left side of swatch, into E position.
- ❖ Knit the working needles in colour A x 4 rows
- ❖ Now push 18 needles back to D position and pull 22 forward to pos.E
- ❖ Knit colour B x 4 rows.

- ❖ Push 24 needles back and pull 16 forward

- ❖ Knit colour C x 4 rows.

- ❖ Push 14 back, pull 26 forward.

- ❖ Knit colour A x 4 rows.

- ❖ Repeat until 40 needles are selected.

- ❖ Try starting with all the needles out in E position, push them back and stripe starting from the **centre** of the swatch.

That is how these lozenge shapes were created.

Try combining the lozenge or rounder shapes with straight angles or the diagonals and chevrons we are about to knit.



- ❖ Note, there will always be a mark or holes where the slant of the stitches changes direction.



- ❖ A short row stripe of viscose and lambswool that has been felted in a washing machine.



Pin your swatches up as you go along, you will see your progress!

Diagonal Striping

This is where it gets complicated.

Go step by step and it will become clear!



- ❖ To make your stripes run diagonally as in this photo simply;
- ❖ Set carriage holding cams to H
- ❖ Start with all needles in working position apart from two at the right side-pull these out to E.
- ❖ Knit 2 rows.
- ❖ Pull next two needles into position E
- ❖ Knit 2 rows.

- ❖ **Move your claw weight according to where you are knitting!**
- ❖ When you change colour depends on the width of your stripes. If it is 4x4 change now.
- ❖ Repeat until all needles are in holding position.

If you begin knitting across the entire row then pull needles out and knit until all needles are selected, take carriage off hold, then knit plain across the entire row. The mark and angle will form a **curve or spiral angle**.

If you short row knit back pushing needles until all are back in working position the mark and angle will form a **straight or mitre angle**.

- ❖ So for your sample, you are knitting a mitre angle.
- ❖ Your needles should all be in position E, push them back to working position, 2 by 2 rows and match the stripes.



- ❖ Notice you have made a swatch with considerably more knit at one selvedge (you have in fact turned a corner!)

To straighten swatch repeat the whole chevron but starting at the opposite edge.

- ❖ Notice the selvedge (vertical edge) of the swatch in first diagonal stripe. Knitting diagonally will always give you this shape.

To continue to knit from your first chevron.....



Knit say 12 rows (if you're still striping stripe here too)

- ❖ Then make another chevron starting at the same edge as the last.
- ❖ Repeat until you've knitted x 4 chevrons

- ❖ Cast off and sew cast off edge to cast on edge and you should have a shape like this photo.

You have made a square with four corners.

It can be incorporated into any garment design.

If used cleverly it can also be a shaping substitute for armholes, shoulders, collars, waist e.t.c.





- ❖ To make a perfect square like this you must move 3 needles every 4 rows.





- ❖ Start to combine your stripes to make a design. On the left is a variation on diagonal knitting.
- ❖ It's been knitted on the diagonal but only one section at a time.



How to Knit a Chevron

This is a bit fiddly to knit but produces stunning results.



- ❖ Start at right side with all needles out in holding position E.
- ❖ Knit colour A until 18 needles are back in working position

- ❖ Knit a 2 row stripe of colour B.
- ❖ So you have 20 needles knitting.
- ❖ Continuing to stripe, as you push 2 needles back you pull two forward from the right edge.



- ❖ So now you are only knitting 20 needles until you reach the left edge where you continue to pull needles into E until all needles are in E.
- ❖ You have made the first section of your chevron.
- ❖ Return knitting from the left edge pushing needles back until 20 needles are in D, then as before push 2 back pull two forward from the left edge until you are back at the right edge.
- ❖ Match stripes to make the chevron.

So, the number of stitches knitted diagonally (here 20) determines the height or angle of you chevron.

- ❖ Use your favourite straight stripe composition and re- knit as a chevron.



- ❖ Use an ombre stripe, as in the photo, in combination with large blocks of plain colour.
- ❖ Change the height of the chevron (i.e. left to right its 15 stitches tall, right to left its 40)
- ❖ The fabric being completely striped in chevrons.



- ❖ Or, use the holding cam to knit diamond shapes-
- ❖ Knit one half at a time (horizontally) including the background.
- ❖ Knit until the fabric is straight
- ❖ Each full diamond has different stripes.

And variations on this.

- ❖ Turn your swatches upside down, sideways, diagonal. Always put them on your body and look in the mirror!
- ❖ Draw your own lines around a body and see if you can knit them.

Search fashion collections for further inspiration on www.style.com



Look through magazines and trend books for striping colour ideas!

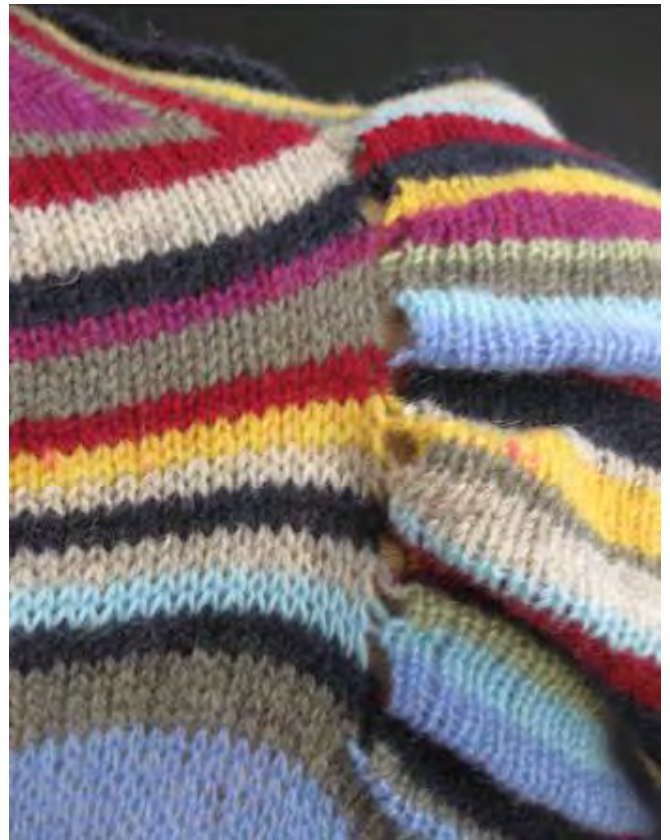


Colourful chevrons looks great!

Many different designers use stripe in their collections -it is how you re-invent them that keeps it modern.

The short row technique and the holding cam are useful for bending stripes and also garment shaping.

This is a swatch that has been knitted with different amounts of rows in sections and been striped at the same time.



- So split your swatch into two sections;
- Put half into holding position.
- Knit 6 rows on the half in working position.
- Knit 4 rows over all needles.
- Repeat and stripe.

Use the tighter sections for fitted places on the body and the excess fabric to move as sleeves or hips.

If you've tried everything I have suggested, you should have a nice big pile of modern stripes!



Place your fabrics on the mannequin, this helps with garment designing!

Glossary

E-wrap *cast on method for finished edge loop yarn around needles from left to right making the shape of a lower case e around each needle while needles are in E position.*

Sts *stitches(abbreviation)*

Prong tool *double ended tools that come with machine either have 1 and 2, 1 and 3, 2 and 3 prongs.*

Latch tool *tool that looks like a machine needle, used for picking up stitches.*

On the left side of the needle bed on machine

Needle position;

A *non working position/ needles will not knit*

B *working position / needles will knit*

D *selected for pattern knitting/ needles will knit*

E *holding position/ needles will knit unless holding cam is switched to H or II*

HP *holding position*

Holding cam *control on carriage on Brother machines N
Or H on Knitmaster I or II. Select H and II for short row knitting, needles selected into position E will NOT knit.*

Swatch *piece of knitting/fabric*

Pointelle *lace knitting*

Eyelet *one stitch lace hole*

1x1 pointelle *1 row of 1 stitch lace holes*

Fashion / fashioning *moving multiple stitches*

Cast off *bind off*

Dress Form *dummy/ mannequin*



Here is our story , well a particular part of it

Sue and I met at a jumble (that`s second hand clothes) sale in our village, Old Basing near Basingstoke, Hampshire in 1978 !!!

After our respective University and Polytechnic Courses we set up in Brighton in 1983. We called our label "Pretty Blue Guns" after one of our favourite Tom Waits` tracks. We were lesser known contemporaries of Body Map, John Flett, Martin Kidman of Joseph and all that crowd of British design hopefuls eons back at the dawn of time.

We were marvellously supported and encouraged by Steve & Iona Hudson, of New Masters, Kings Road, London and then by Stuart Malloy & Peter Sidell (now owner of The Library, in South Kensington) of Jones of Kings Road and later Floral Street. We had US sales to Macys and Neiman Marcus and various other accounts but after about 3 years we couldn`t really make the line pay, nevertheless our garments had come to the notice of an Italian company called Agenco of Modena and as a result we got great experience for the first time working in Italy on one of their knitwear lines called Portobello`s. This and Sue`s earlier employment in the Far East with US brand Williwear gave us the necessary commercial understanding to separately work for Next , Henry Lloyd and Boules. All these were very useful experiences.

Pretty Blue Guns had also been noticed by our now long-time friends Chris Matthews & Philippa George of ` The Collection`, the design studio for whom we started producing one off knit designs in 1987 and still work with today. Our own design collection started with a first trip to New York in 1991 under the catchy banner of our combined surnames `Dykes Enticknap` which luckily in year 2000 with the on-set of the dot com age was transmuted into the rather more generic user friendly Knit-1 Ltd www.knit-1.com . Design sales were growing rapidly and we needed more space so moved to our existing premises, a 3,500 sq ft former engineering works which we completely refurbished to our design business requirements. We have sold designs to and worked with most of the big global fashion brands.

In 2008 we set up our Design Courses www.knitdesigncourses.com . Somewhat frustrated by the practical skills levels which were lacking in the portfolios of knit graduates and undergraduates we had been seeing for some time we set about devising our intensive courses. We wanted to offer a completely new way to learn knit design & make that would appeal to not just students, technicians and tutors but industry professionals, ambitious designers and knit design enthusiasts. In fact the courses appeal to any aspiring individual wanting to progress in the field of machine knit design and knitwear for the fashion industry.

The courses take place in the design business environment offered by Knit-1 Ltd at the company's well equipped premises in Brighton, UK. Many elements of the courses have references to selected high profile customers of the company which further distinguishes the courses from what can be offered by traditional academic institutions. Hence we can deliver the required practical skills to advanced levels in knitwear, knit design & make, print and embroidery in rapid time.

The courses are now very well established and have proved themselves through the positive feedback received and the attainment of jobs in the fashion industry by course participants. It takes the knowledge of a fashion business to know what other businesses want from their prospective employees. Furthermore many of our participants have also set up their own businesses after taking one of our courses.

That's it so far.....

www.knit-1.com

www.knitdesigncourses.com

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